



Applied Data Mining

**— Week 2—
Spring 2026**

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Outline

- Data Objects and Attribute Types 
- Basic Statistical Descriptions of Data

Data Objects

- Data sets are made up of data objects.
- A **data object** represents an entity.
- Examples:
 - sales database: customers, store items, sales
 - medical database: patients, treatments
 - university database: students, professors, courses
- Also called *samples*, *examples*, *instances*, *data points*, *objects*, *tuples*.
- Data objects are described by **attributes**.
- Database (rows -> data objects; columns -> attributes)

Attributes



- **Attribute** (or **dimensions, features, variables**): a data field, representing a characteristic or feature of a data object.
 - E.g., customer_ID, name, address
- A set of attributes used to describe a given object is called an attribute vector (or feature vector).
- The distribution of data involving one attribute (or variable) is called uni-variate.
- A bi-variate distribution involves two attributes.

Attributes



- Attribute Types:
 - Nominal (Related to Names)
 - Binary (Only two states)
 - Numeric: quantitative
 - Interval-scaled
 - Ratio-scaled

Attribute Types

- **Nominal (categorical):** means “relating to names.”
- The values of a **nominal attribute** are symbols, *names of things*, categories and states.
- *Hair_color* = {auburn, black, blond, brown, grey, red, white}
- Marital status, occupation, ID numbers, zip codes etc
- **Binary**
 - Nominal attribute with only 2 states (0 and 1)
- Where 0 typically means that the attribute is absent, and 1 means that it is present.
- Also referred to as **Boolean** if the two states correspond to *true* and *false*.

Attribute Types

- Symmetric binary: Both outcomes equally important, carry the same weight. e.g., gender
- Asymmetric binary: outcomes not equally important.
 - e.g., medical test (positive vs. negative)
 - Convention: assign 1 to most important outcome (e.g., HIV positive)
- **Ordinal**
 - Values have a meaningful order (ranking) but magnitude between successive values is not known.
 - *Size* = {*small, medium, large*}, grades, army rankings

Numeric Attribute Types

- **Numeric Attributes (integer or real-valued)**
 - Interval-scaled
 - Ratio-scaled
- **Interval**
 - Measured on a scale of **equal-sized units**
 - Values have order
 - E.g., *temperature in C° or F°, calendar dates*
 - *0°C does NOT mean “no temperature”*
✗ 20°C is NOT twice as hot as 10°C ✗

Numeric Attribute Types

■ Ratio

- Inherent **zero-point** (Zero represents the **complete absence** of the quantity being measured)
- We can speak of values as being an order of magnitude larger than the unit of measurement (10 K° is twice as high as 5 K°).
- Weight 0 kg means no weight
- 10 kg is twice 5 kg

Discrete vs. Continuous Attributes

- **Discrete Attribute**

- Has only a finite set of values
 - E.g., zip codes, profession, or the set of words in a collection of documents
 - {44000, 54000, 60000} Even though they are numbers, they are:
 - Labels
 - Not continuous quantities
 - Finite possible value
- Sometimes, represented as integer variables
- Note: Binary attributes are a special case of discrete attributes: {0,1 } Only two possible values → finite → countable → discrete

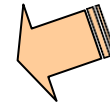
Discrete vs. Continuous Attributes

- **Continuous Attribute**

- Has real numbers as attribute values
 - E.g., temperature, height, or weight
 - 25°C, 25.1°C, 25.12°C, 25.123°C ... Between 25 and 26, there are infinitely many possible values.
- Practically, real values can only be measured and represented using a finite number of digits
- Continuous attributes are typically represented as floating-point variables

Outline

- Data Objects and Attribute Types
- Basic Statistical Descriptions of Data



Basic Statistical Descriptions of Data

- Motivation

- To identify properties of the data and highlight which data values should be treated as noise or outliers.
 - To better understand the data: central tendency, variation and spread

- Central tendency

- Location of the middle or center of a data distribution
- Mean, median, mode, and midrange

Measuring the Central Tendency

- Mean (algebraic measure) (sample vs. population):

Note: n is sample size (Number of values selected from the population) and N is population size (Total number of values in the entire population).

Example: If a class has **100 students ($N = 100$)**, but you collect marks of **20 students ($n = 20$)**:

Mean of 100 students → divide by **100**

Mean of 20 students → divide by **20**

$$\bar{x} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n x_i \quad \mu = \frac{\sum x}{N}$$

$$\bar{x} = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n w_i x_i}{\sum_{i=1}^n w_i}$$

- Weighted arithmetic mean:

Example:

Suppose you have three exam scores: 80, 90, and 70, with weights 20%, 50%, and 30% respectively.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Weighted Mean} &= \frac{(80 \times 0.2) + (90 \times 0.5) + (70 \times 0.3)}{0.2 + 0.5 + 0.3} \\ &= \frac{16 + 45 + 21}{1} = 82 \end{aligned}$$

So the weighted average score is 82, not the simple average $(80 + 90 + 70)/3 = 80$.

Measuring the Central Tendency

- Median:
 - Middle value if odd number of values, or average of the middle two values otherwise
- Mode
 - Value that occurs most frequently in the data
- Data sets with one, two, or three modes are respectively called **unimodal**, **bimodal**, and **trimodal**.

Number of Modes:

Unimodal: Only one value occurs most frequently.

Bimodal: Two values occur with the same highest frequency.

Trimodal: Three values occur with the same highest frequency.

Multimodal: More than three values occur with the same highest frequency

- Dataset: 3, 5, 3, 8, 9, 3 → Mode = 3 (occurs 3 times)
- Dataset: 2, 4, 4, 6, 6 → Modes = 4 and 6 (bimodal)

Measuring the Central Tendency

- Midrange

- It can also be used to assess the central tendency of a numeric data set.
- It is the average of the largest and smallest values in the set.

Example 2.6 Mean. Suppose we have the following values for *salary* (in thousands of dollars), shown in increasing order: 30, 36, 47, 50, 52, 52, 56, 60, 63, 70, 70, 110. Using Eq. (2.1), we have

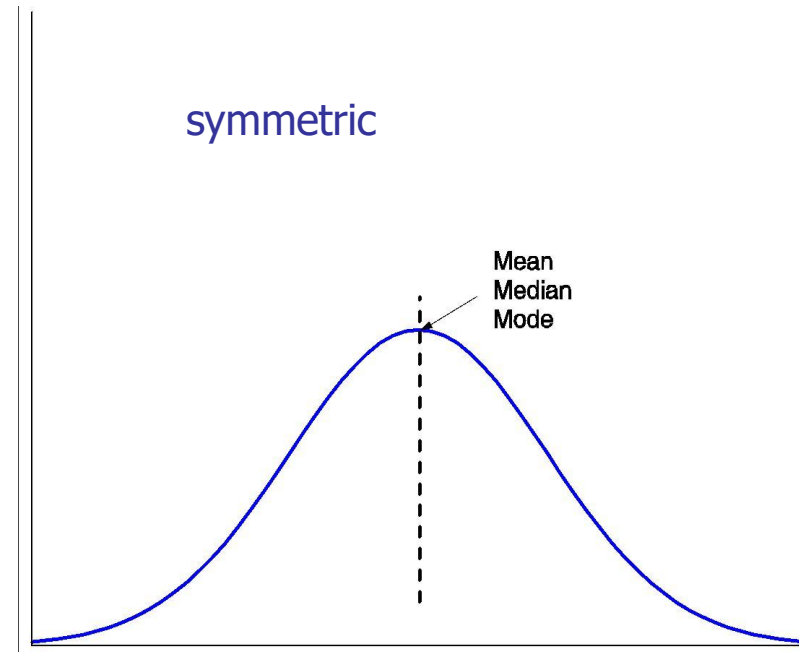
$$\begin{aligned}\bar{x} &= \frac{30 + 36 + 47 + 50 + 52 + 52 + 56 + 60 + 63 + 70 + 70 + 110}{12} \\ &= \frac{696}{12} = 58.\end{aligned}$$

Thus, the mean salary is \$58,000. ■

Midrange. The midrange of the data of Example 2.6 is $\frac{30,000+110,000}{2} = \$70,000$.

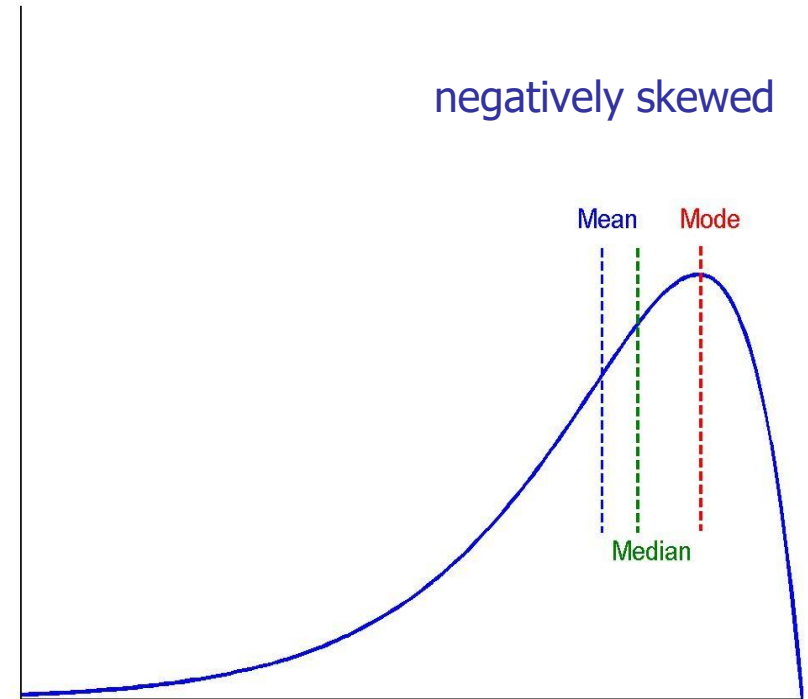
Symmetric vs. Skewed Data

- Median, mean and mode of symmetric, positively and negatively skewed data
- For unimodal frequency curve with perfect **symmetric** data distribution, the mean, median, and mode are all at the same center value



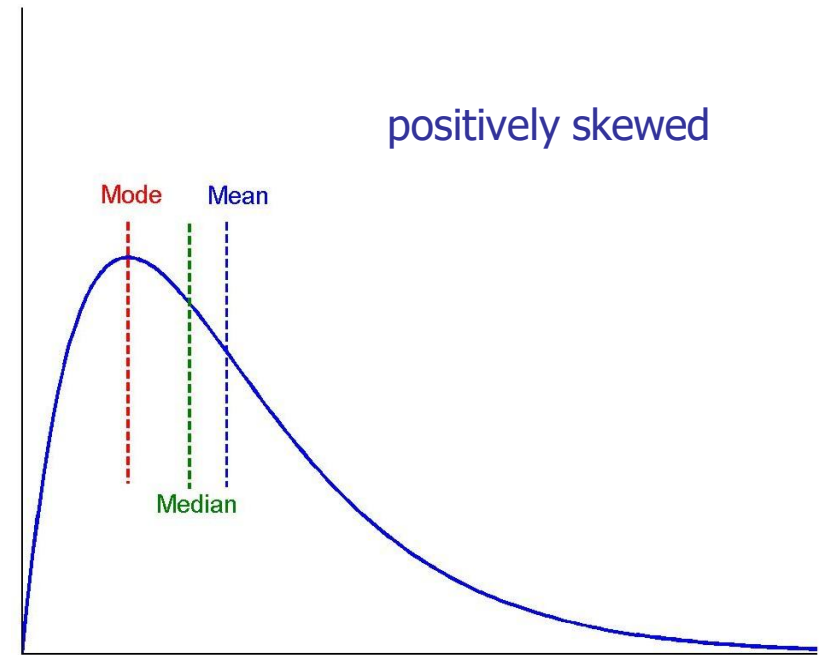
Symmetric vs. Skewed Data

- **For negatively skewed,**
the mode occurs at a
value greater than the
median



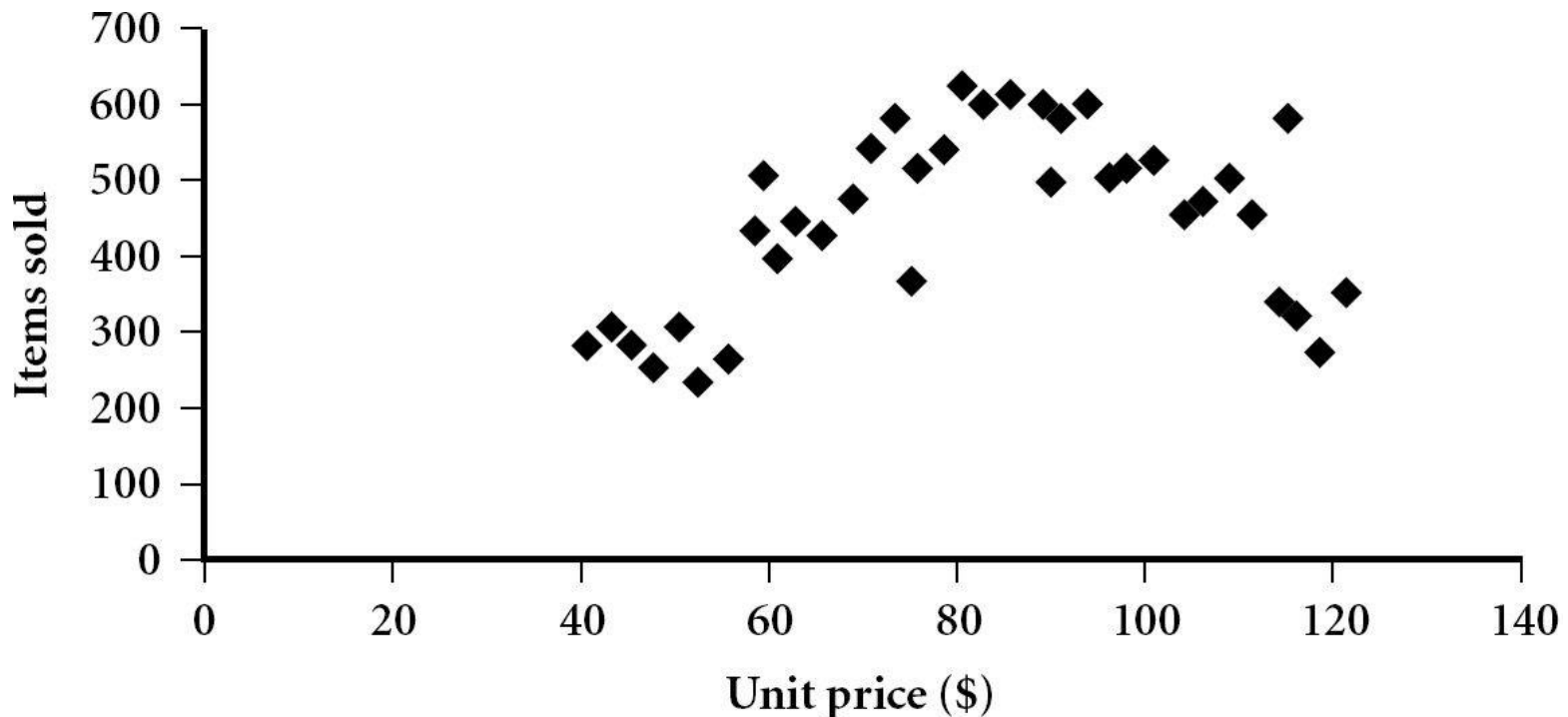
Symmetric vs. Skewed Data

- For **positively skewed**, the mode occurs at a value that is smaller than the median

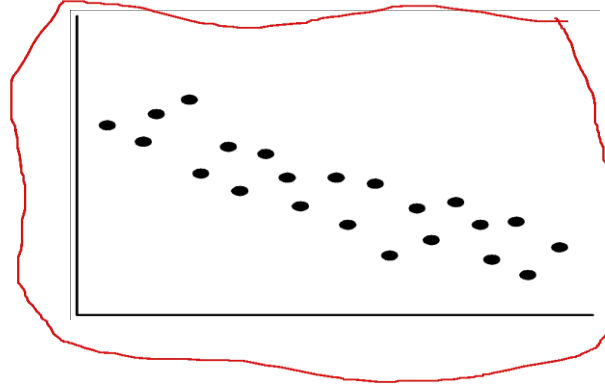
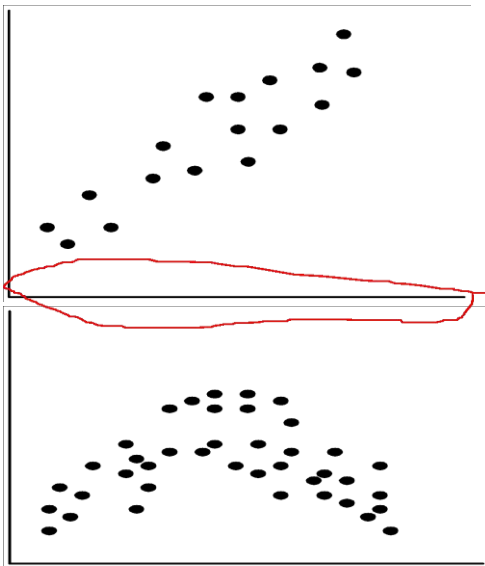


Scatter plot

- Provides a first look at bi-variate data to see clusters of points, outliers, etc
- Each pair of values is treated as a pair of coordinates and plotted as points in the plane



Positively and Negatively Correlated Data



- The left half fragment is positively correlated
- The right half is negative correlated

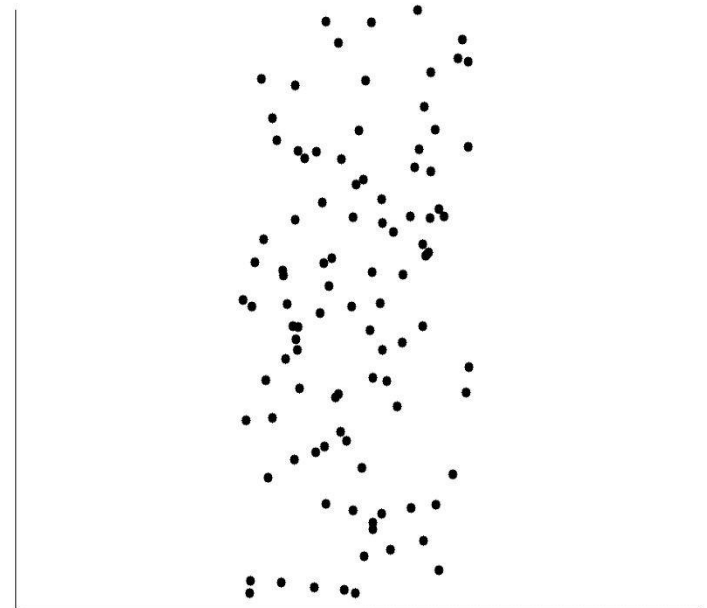
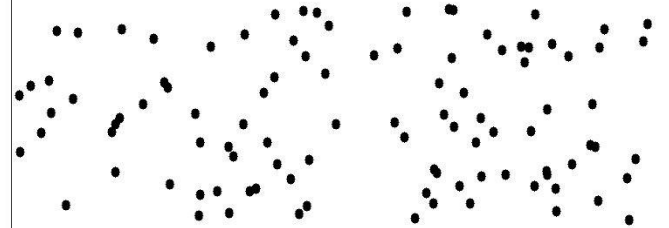
Type	Relationship	Correlation (r)	Example
Positive Correlation	Both increase or decrease together	0 to +1	Hours studied vs. marks
Negative Correlation	One increases, other decreases	0 to -1	Social media vs. exam marks

Uncorrelated Data



Graph

- Points are scattered **randomly** on a graph, **no upward or downward trend**.
- Even if the points move a little, **no clear linear or non-linear pattern** exists





Any Question